CDE2501 SUSTAINABLE SYSTEMS FOR LIVEABLE CITIES

SITE GUIDE FOR

WOODLANDS

AY 2025 – 2026 SEMESTER 2

Introduction to Site Guides

Welcome to Liveable Cities! Each of your teams will be working on a site from the following choices – Jurong, Woodlands, Punggol, Bras Basah-Bugis, Chinatown, Tampines and Queenstown.

To help you better navigate your site, we have created site guides to serve as starter packs to help you dive into your projects as quickly as possible.

We provide the following information for each site guide:

1. Maps marking the suggested boundaries of the sites
2. Prompts that spotlight key issues which you can apply to develop your project
3. A list of references to assist with your research

While we welcome you to use the prompts, you do not need to strictly adhere to them. Feel free to combine ideas from the prompts and/or explore other urban issues you are passionate about.

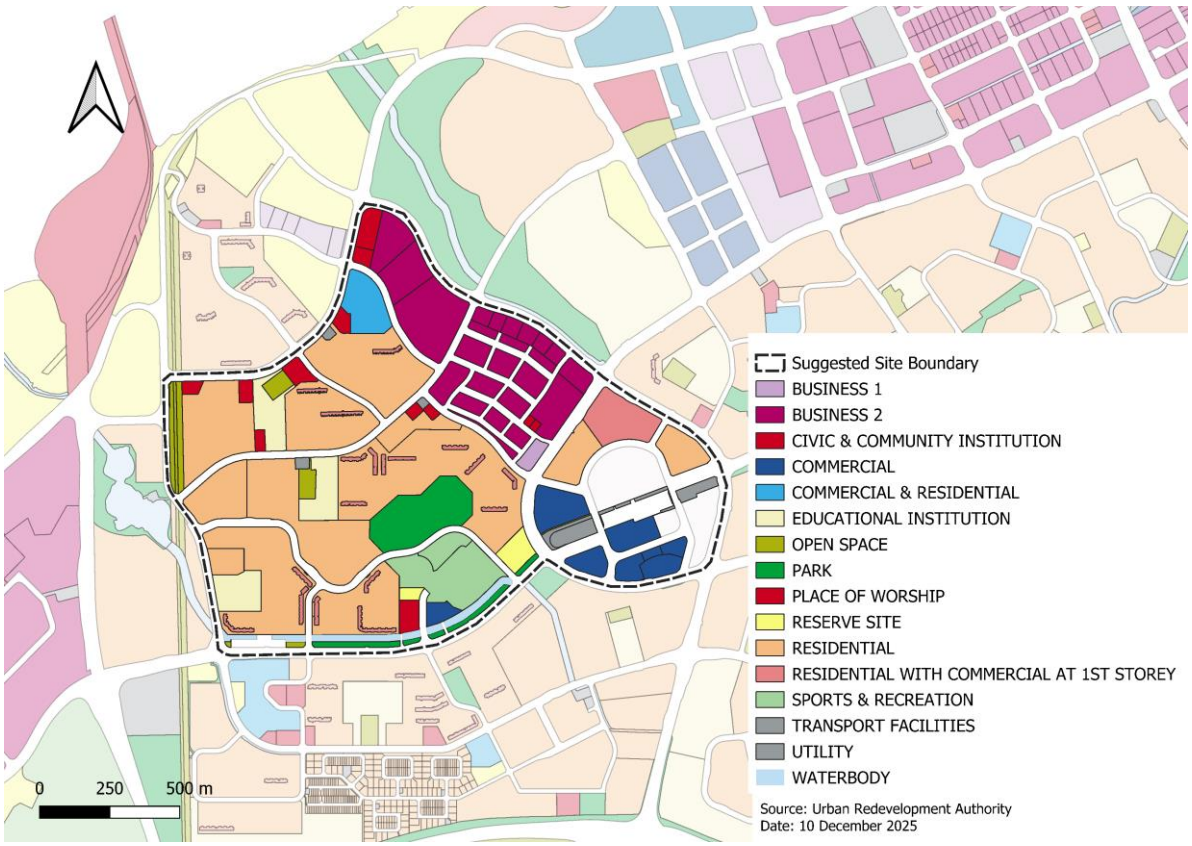
Note: As you learn more about the site and discover what interests the team most, you can also choose to focus on a section of the site and/or extend the site boundaries a little to areas relevant to the issue you are studying.

Woodlands

This site contains the following landmarks:

- Transport Nodes e.g. Woodlands MRT, Woodlands Temporary Bus Interchange, Marsiling MRT
- Green Spaces e.g. Woodlands Town Park East
- Community and Recreation Spaces e.g. Woodlands Sports Centre, Marsiling Community Club
- Religious Sites e.g. Sri Siva Krishna Temple, Hong Tho Bilw Temple, New Life Bible-Presbyterian Church
- Industrial Areas e.g. Marsiling Industrial Estate
- Retail e.g. Causeway Point, Marsiling Mall
- Education e.g. Woodlands Secondary School, Marsiling Primary School, Marsiling Secondary School

You can also consider exploring other potential areas in this site as well.



Prompts

- Woodlands is the place of entry for many workers from Malaysia, being close to the Causeway and the Woodlands Checkpoint. Are there sufficient amentities in Woodlands for them and the residents of the town?
- The colours on the land use map of Woodlands indicate some areas with Business 1 and Business 2 land use. Business 1 and Business 2 land uses allow for industrial developments, which comprise factories, warehouses, telecommunication and utility buildings. Depending on the nature of their activities, clean and light industries are allowed in Business 1 (B1) zone. General and special industries are located in Business 2 (B2) zone. Find out what specific industries are in Woodlands. Are they still relevant to the present-day economy?
- Are there enough recreational spaces catering to the needs and wants of the people living in Woodlands?
- Given that Woodlands is both a residential and industrial area, and welcomes Malaysians from across the border, is Woodlands managing the flows of transport and people well?

- There still exist smaller heartland shops in Woodlands, apart from the larger chain stores that can be found in places such as Causeway Point. Are these heartland shops still relevant to the needs and wants of residents and visitors?
- Woodlands consists of a mix of newer BTO flats and older flats. Are there any impacts of this mix between old and new flats? What implications does it have for the mix of demographics in Woodlands?

Starter References

As you read the following references, think about:

- What are the intentions that URA and other government agencies have for Woodlands?
- What are the strategies or interventions they are planning to make to achieve these intentions?
- Are these strategies or interventions sufficient to achieve these intentions?
- In the first place, are these intentions good for Woodlands in helping it to achieve High Quality of Life, Sustainable Environment and Competitive Economy?

URA's Draft Master Plan 2025 for North Region (including Woodlands): North Region | URA Master Plan

Singapore Infopedia, Woodlands: Woodlands

URA's plans for developing Woodlands into a regional centre: Woodlands Regional Centre -
Key Commercial Hub in the North

HDB's Woodlands Town Design Guide: Woodlands-Town-Design-Guide.pdf

URA's Design Guidelines for Woodlands Regional Centre: Woodlands Regional Centre

Woodlands is home to various heartland areas that feature everyday coffee shops, general stores, mobile phone shops and medical clinics. In recent years, there have been increasing debates about whether these neighborhood centers will stand the test of time. The following links detail more information about this:

Housing Development Board (HDB) study about retail shops in heartland neighborhoods in Singapore: Reinvigorating Heartland Shops: Heartland Shops Study Summary Report

Channel NewsAsia (CNA) article about the evolving retail landscape in heartland neighborhoods in Singapore: Are our heartlands losing their charm? Residents voice their concerns as new F&B, retail entrants populate neighbourhoods - CNA